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Postal Manual Volume II – Chapter XI - Misc. Rules

DISCLAIMER: *This booklet has been prepared strictly from an examination point of view. While every effort has been made to ensure accuracy and the inclusion of recent changes, amendments, and updates to the relevant Acts, Rules, and Regulations, this document is intended as a study aid only. Readers and students are strongly recommended to refer to official government sources or gazettes for the most reliable and authoritative information.*

Postal Manual Volume II - Chapter XI - Misc. Rules

MISCELLANEOUS RULES

Rule 611. Rules for Official display of National Flag (i) *Public Buildings* Normally the flag should be flown only on important public buildings such as High Courts, Secretariats, Commissioner's Offices, Collectorates, Jail and Offices of the District Boards, Municipalities and Zila Parishads.

(ii) *Display of National Flag on National Holidays* The display of the National Flag is unrestricted on National Days (1) Republic Day, (2) National week **6th to 13th April**, (3) Independence Day, (4) Mahatma Gandhi's birthday, and (5) Any other particular day of National rejoicing. There is no harm if the flag is displayed at the top of buildings which accommodates besides Posts and Telegraphs Offices, other offices or residence on the days referred to above. All P. & T. Offices housed in departmental buildings should have permanent flag masts provided. In so far as non-departmental buildings are concerned, the National Flag should be flown wherever flag mast has been provided. If no flag mast is provided, the matter should be taken up with the Land Lords for providing flag masts in the rented buildings.

(iii) *Display with flag of other Nations and of United Nations* With permission of the Government, the National Flag and the flags of other countries may be displayed on occasions such as cultural shows, exhibitions, musical concerts, film festivals etc. sponsored by the Diplomatic or Consular representatives of the foreign Governments. When displayed in a straight line with Flags of other countries, the National Flag shall be on the extreme right; (i. e.) if any observer were to stand in the centre of the row on the Flags facing the audience, the National Flag should be to his extreme right. Flags of foreign countries shall proceed as from the National Flag in alphabetical order on the basis of English versions of the names of the countries concerned. It would be permissible in such a case to begin and also to include the National Flag in the normal country-wise alphabetical order. The National Flag shall be hoisted first and lowered last. In case Flags are to be flown in an open circle i. e. in an arc or a semi-circle, the same procedure shall be adopted, as is indicated in the preceding clause of this paragraph. In case Flags are to be flown in a closed i.e. complete circle, the National Flag shall mark the beginning of the circle and Flags of other countries should proceed in a clockwise manner until the last flag

is placed next to the National Flag. It is not necessary to use separate National Flags to mark the beginning and the end of the circle of Flags. The National Flag shall also be included in its alphabetical order in such a closed circle. When the Flag is displayed against a wall with another Flag from crossed staffs, it shall be on the right (i. e.) the Flag's own right, and its staff shall be in front of the staff of the other Flag. When the United Nations' Flag is flown alongwith the National Flag, it can be displayed on either side of the National Flag. The practice is that the National Flag is displayed on the extreme right with reference to the direction which it is facing (i. e.) extreme left of an observer facing the masts flying the Flags. When flown with other flags, the flag masts shall be of equal size irrespective of the number of other foreign flags besides the National Flag. International usage forbids the flag of one nation above that of another nation in time of peace. The National Flag shall not flown from a single mast-head simultaneously with any other flag or flags. There shall be separate mast-heads for different flags.

(iv) *State Mourning-Flying of the National Flag at Half Mast during the period of* The National Flag is to be flown at half mast during the period of State-Mourning only on those buildings where it is flown daily as given in (i) above.

(v) *National Anthem* 'Jana Gana Mana' is the National Anthem of India and 'Vande Mataram' which has played a historic part in the struggle for India's freedom, shall be honoured equally with 'Jana Gana Mana' and shall have equal status with it. Whenever both these songs are to be sung or played on any occasion 'Vande Mataram' should be sung or played at the beginning and 'Jana Gana Mana' at the end of the function. Only the standard choral and orchestral versions of these songs may be sung or played. The authorised versions are available in approved gramophone records.

Rule 611-A. Naming of Post Offices and changing the names of the existing ones (a) Post Offices should invariably be named after the names of the villages, towns or localities in which they are located and not after the names of individuals or institutions unless there are very exceptional circumstances for it and orders of the Director-General, Posts have been obtained. Particular attention should be paid to the spelling of the names of places after which the Post Offices are named. The spelling should be verified from the local revenue records and confirmed by the Regional Director of the Surveyor-General of India giving full description of the location of the Post Office with reference to distance and

direction from the nearest significant village or town, to facilitate its location on the maps maintained by the Surveyor-General of India.

(b) Changes in the names of Post Offices should be discouraged as far as possible. Where there are compelling reasons to justify a change, the principle laid down in Rule 611(a) should be strictly followed. Any departure from this principle which is contemplated in exceptional cases should be referred to the Director-General, Posts with a sketch map of the locality and the following information :-

- (i) Existing name of the office.
- (ii) Date of Opening.
- (iii) Reasons for naming the Post Office as such.
- (iv) Reasons for change now desired.
- (v) Spelling of the proposed name as per Revenue and Survey of India records.

NOTE 1.-When identical names of Post Offices exist in more than one district the name of the district should be added to the name of the Post Office e. g., Dumra-Purnea and Dumra-Saharsa. Purnea and Saharsa are the names of Districts. When, however, two or more Post Offices in the same Districts bear the same name, the name of Tehsil or adjacent village or locality should be suffixed to the name of the Post Office, e. g., Naraspuram Kummetta P. O. Kummetta is the name of adjoining village.

NOTE 2. It should also be ensured, as far as possible, that the names of Railway stations and Post Offices located in the same area or locality are identical e. g., Vijayawada P. O. and Railway Station and not as Vijayavada P. O. & Bezwada Railway Station.

NOTE 3. Naming of post offices on the basis of names of important buildings should be considered only if the buildings have been built and donated to the Government and all such cases of deviation from Rule 611-A should be with the prior approval of DG (P). The post offices should not be named after the names of buildings which have either been rented or a small portion of which has been allowed to be used by the post offices even free of charge (Letter No. 2/34/76-MI dated 9-8-76).

Rule 612. Deleted.

Rule 613. General rules regarding correspondence Official correspondence should always be concise, and should, as far as possible, be complete in itself. As a general rule, each communication should contain reference to **one** subject only.

Rule 614. Unless it is otherwise prescribed in the rules or in any special order, no officer should correspond direct with an authority superior to the officer to whom he is immediately subordinate except in reply to communications received direct by him.

Rule 615. All officers should, when submitting any report, proposal, design, estimate, application, etc. state distinctly their own opinion on the subject. Letters relating to proposals concerning other departments should, whenever necessary, contain reference to the opinion of the departmental officer concerned (e. g. in the case of a building of the office occupying it) and of the senior officer of the other department on the spot.

Rule 616. Except where it is specifically prescribed ink, other than blue, should not be used on official correspondence or in official records.

Rule 617. On all matters of small importance, Officers-in-charge of Post Office and Railway Mail Service offices should correspond direct with each other. An Inspector Posts will receive all correspondences affecting branch post offices and should dispose of such correspondence himself without reference to his Superintendent except when the orders of the Superintendent are required, or when the questions raised are beyond the Inspector's powers or capacity to deal with, or when they relate to some special class of correspondence which, under the orders of the Superintendent, must be submitted to him. The Inspector should use simple language in his correspondence so that it can be understood by the officials with whom he deals. The Superintendent should, however, take every opportunity of ascertaining whether the inspector has been negligent or faulty in the disposal of correspondence.

Rule 618. When a correspondence relates only to some petty irregularity, the original communication, replies and final orders should, if space permits, follow one after another on the original document. When several communications are written on the same document, they should, in addition to the ordinary correspondence Nos., bear blue pencil

serial Nos. so as to show their chronological order. Communications in the form of memoranda with half-margin for a reply will often be found useful in such cases.

Rule 619. In communicating with officers of the department, subscription "Yours faithfully" should be used. Writing in the third person must ordinarily be avoided.

Rule 620. As the head record office is a branch of the office of the Superintendent, Railway Mail Service, all communications between the Superintendent and the head record assistant should be in the form of office notes, of which copies need not be kept, nor should such communications be entered in the correspondence register.

Rule 621. In sub-offices, every communication addressed to the Superintendent or Inspector should be impressed with the combined date-stamp.

Rule 622. (1) Postmasters of offices which are not offices of foreign exchange, are prohibited from addressing foreign Postal Administrations direct on any subject, and any reference that it may be necessary for them to make regarding foreign articles, should be addressed to the Indian office of foreign exchange concerned. (2) Offices of exchange, their controlling officers and heads of Circles should observe the following procedure in their correspondence with foreign countries.

- (a) On purely routine matters, such as issuing or replying to "reclamations", or conveying or asking for information on printed forms which have been prescribed in International agreements, offices of exchange and their controlling officers in India may correspond direct with corresponding offices of exchange in the other countries.
- (b) On matters which involve collection or furnishing of factual information, particularly in regard to complaints, Heads of Circles may correspond with their counterparts in other countries. The term "counterparts" may be taken to include Heads of postal administrations of small Countries such as Afghanistan, Malaya, Nepal or the British colonies and possessions (not Dominions).
- (c) In all other cases, the matter should be referred to the Director-General who will decide whether he should himself correspond with the foreign administration, or do so through diplomatic channels in accordance with the instructions

communicated in the Ministry of External Affairs Office Memo. No. D-3573-GII/51 dated the **31st August, 1951**. A relevant extract therefrom is given below :-

"As regards countries where India is represented, communications involving negotiations, or questions of policy or of such importance that, even though not involving questions of principle or policy at the initial stage, they might eventually lead to negotiations or to policy decisions, should pass through the External Affairs Ministry. Other communications may be made direct by the Ministry concerned, the Ministry of External Affairs being kept informed. All communications to foreign Governments should invariably to be made through the Representative of the Government of India in that country, and NOT direct. Omission to do so places the Heads of our missions abroad in an embarrassing position. They are put in false position with the Government concerned. At the same time the Government of India lose the benefit of whatever information, advice or assistance they may be able to give in the light of their local knowledge. There is no objection to direct correspondence between technical officers in the attached and subordinate offices of the Ministries e. g., Director, Indian Agricultural Research Institute, Director, Geological Survey of India, Director, Central Rice Research Institute, with their counterparts or with non-official technical organisations in foreign countries on purely technical matters. But copies of such direct correspondence should invariably be endorsed to the Ministry of External Affairs and the Head of the Indian Mission concerned. If the correspondence on scientific matters is incomplete without an exchange of specimens, there is no objection to the exchange of scientific materials where necessary."

Rule 623. Officers-in-charge of Post Offices and Railway Mail Service offices are personally responsible for the proper conduct of correspondence in other offices. They must themselves open all correspondence addressed to their offices and either take prompt action themselves or see that prompt action is taken by the staff. Special attention should be paid to the disposal of reminders and calls for v. p. money orders. EXCEPTION.-In first class head offices, this duty may be performed by assistant postmasters, if they are invested with the powers of postmasters in the branch or branches under their control. But the postmaster himself is expected to exercise an effective control over the correspondence of his office specially with respect to reminders and calls for v. p. money orders.

Rule 624. Correspondence registers Correspondence registers in the prescribed form should be maintained as shown below :-

Name of the Register	To be maintained by
(a) Inward register of correspondence received from the Head of the Circle.	Divisional Supdts. of Post Offices and RMS and First Class Postmasters.
(b) Inward register of correspondence received from the Divisional Office.	(1) Inspector Posts (2) All Post Offices (3) All Record Offices
(c) Inward Register of correspondence in Form Corr. 2 for entry of all references received concerning public complaints.	(1) All Head Offices (2) All sub-offices in Gazetted and Selection Grades. (3) All Record Offices (H. R. O. & S. R. O.s) in Selection Grade.

The offices mentioned against (a) & (b) should also maintain the outward Register of miscellaneous correspondence despatched. Inspector Posts working on R. M. S. side need not maintain it.

Rule 625. The entries in the registers should be numbered in a consecutive series commencing from the **1st of April** of each year. As regards correspondence despatched, the No. of the letter despatched will be the case-mark of the file on the subject and the Serial No. from the outward register will be assigned only to those communications (e. g., error extracts forwarded in original) which are not important enough to justify fresh case being opened for them.

NOTE. *The case-mark should invariably be noted in correspondence registers under the No. assigned to the communication in the registers, and also wherever the No. is recorded the case-mark being considered a portion of the No. When a file has been destroyed in the usual course, the fact should be noted in the registers.*

Rule 626. Demi-official correspondence Demi-official correspondence should be numbered and copies made and recorded in the same manner as official correspondence. When information is called for officially it must be given officially.

Rule 627. Correspondence with the Director-General All communications for the Director-General must be sent through the usual official channel and officers, when passing on communications, should invariably endorse them with such remarks as may be called for. When, however, letters or telegrams are addressed direct to an officer by the Director-General, they must be replied to direct and not through the immediate superior of the person addressed. With this exception no officer serving under the orders of the Head of a Circle is authorised to address the Director-General direct.

Rule 628. The following instructions apply to communications to the Directorate on official matters : (a) Communications from the Heads of Circles and other authorities directly under the Director General-

- (i) References to the Director General should be in the form of official letters. They should invariably be type-written or computer print outs and addressed to the "Director General" by designation and not by name. If it is desired that the communications should receive the special attention of any officer of the Directorate the name of the officer may be indicated in brackets in the address e. g., "Director General, Posts (Shri XYZ)".
- (ii) Any communication relating to proposals for modification of rules, procedure or forms and all matters of importance and policy should ordinarily be signed by the Head of the Circle or Head of the Office himself. In Special cases, however, the Head of a Circle or Office may authorise an officer subordinate to him, of a rank not lower than a Director, to sign such communications. Communications relating to ordinary and routine matters may, however be signed by any Gazetted Officer. An officer other than the Head of the Circle, or Administrative Office should normally sign as on his behalf thus "for P. M. G", or other similar appropriate expression. There is no objection, however, to officers signing communications over their own personal designations provided it is indicated in the body of the communication that it is being sent under the directive of the Head of the Office or Circle.
- (iii) Replies to U. O. references from the Directorate should be given in the same manner and should be signed either by the Head of the Office himself or an officer not below the rank of a Director who may be authorised by him in this behalf.

- (iv) As far as possible, communications to the Directorate should indicate the Sections in the Directorate to which the subject matter pertains. For this purpose Heads of Circles and other offices who send frequent communications to the Directorate should obtain from the Directorate information as to the distribution of items of work amongst the Sections in the Directorate.
- (v) More than one subject should not be dealt with in the same communication.

(b) Communications from other offices- Officers not directly under the Director General should not normally send direct communications to the Director General. They may, however, address communications direct when specifically required to do so by general or special orders issued from time to time. Such letters should be type-written/computer print outs and signed by the Head of the Office himself.

Rule 628-A. Deleted.

Rule 629. Correspondence forms Books of correspondence forms (which may be used either singly or with carbonic paper), envelopes and service postcards are supplied to all offices.

Rule 630. Postcards should be used for all departmental correspondence of a routine character, e. g. reports regarding minor irregularities, intimations of causes of delay in delivery of articles, etc.

Rule 630-A. Form Corr-22 should be used (with carbon paper, if necessary) for unimportant correspondence provided that no special form has been prescribed for the purpose in the book of standard printed forms. For correspondence of important nature, Form Corr-40 should be used.

Rule 631. The officer in-charge of an office will be responsible to ensure that envelopes and books of correspondence forms are not used for any purpose other than that for which they are provided. Any official observing any infringement of this rule should bring it to the notice of his immediate superior. *Note: The Postmaster's personal duties prescribed in this rule may, under the orders of the Head of the Circle, be performed by the deputy postmaster, assistant postmaster in the case of head offices and by the deputy sub-postmaster, assistant sub-postmaster in the case of sub-offices.*

Rule 632. Covers containing official documents All official documents despatched on the same date and to the same office should, if possible, be enclosed in one envelope except due returns for Audit offices and other documents which it may be necessary to send under registered covers.

Rule 633. Covers containing official correspondence which are not of a confidential nature, should be addressed to the officers for whom they are intended by their official designations only i. e. without indicating their names. The word "Urgent" should be written on the cover of any letter which requires immediate attention. Covers containing important or valuable papers should be sent registered.

Rule 633-A. Correspondence from the head office to one of its sub-offices or branch offices in direct account with the head office and vice versa should be enclosed loose in the account bag or b. o. bag, as the case may be. When an important document is sent, it should be entered in the S.O. slip, S.O.'s daily account, B.O. slip or B.O. daily account, as the case may be. Covers containing correspondence exchanged between other offices should be registered only when they contain important document which cannot be replaced if lost. Cases of unnecessary registration of covers which do not contain important documents should be treated as an irregularity and noted in the error book.

Rule 634. Covers supplied should be used with economy, care being taken that they are not disproportionately large as compared with the contents. In opening a cover, only the economy label should be torn off and the cover itself should be preserved, as far as practicable for future use.

Rule 635. Initialing and signing documents Whenever it is stated in the relevant rule or departmental form that documents should be initialled, the initials of the officer responsible for the entries are a sufficient attestation. In other cases documents should be signed in full. All officials are strictly forbidden to use facsimile stamp of their signature or initials for the purpose of signing or initialing official documents.

Rule 636. Erasures forbidden All books, accounts, journals and documents must be neatly, clearly and carefully written up or filled in. Erasure of any entry once made is strictly forbidden. On identifying a mistake, the correction should be recorded in red ink above the erroneous entry which should be scored out also with red ink, but in such a

manner as to leave it still legible. Corrections must always be attested by the initials of the officer responsible.

Rule 637. Case-mark system The correspondence in the offices of Heads of Circles, Superintendents of Post Offices and Railway Mail Service and head postmasters should be arranged in files under the case-mark system. Under this system the whole of the office correspondence is divided into several main divisions, each dealing with a separate subject, and to each of these divisions is assigned a letter of the alphabet. The main divisions are generally as follows:-

I. Office of Heads of Circles

File Head	Subject (Section of the Circle Office)
A & P	Accounts & Pension.
STY	Office Stock & Stationery.
Bgt.	Budget.
Bldg.	Building.
CR	Central Registry.
CPT	Complaints.
Eng.	Engineering.
Est.	Establishment.
Est. (Plg.)	Establishment (Planning).
Inv.	Investigation.
Mails	Mails & Sorting.
O & M	O & M.
PLI	Postal Life Insurance.
SB	Savings Bank.
Staff	Staff.
SD	Stock Depot.
Tech.	Technical.
WLF	Technical (Welfare).
TFC	Traffic.
Vig.	Vigilance.
GEN	General.

NOTE. Where there are separate Accounts and Pension Sections, these Sections should be identified by the index letters 'AC' and 'PEN', respectively. If there are more than one Accounts Sections, the index letters should be 'ACA' and 'ACB' and so on. Where there are more than one Section dealing with staff, the index letters for these Sections should be 'Staff A' and 'Staff B', and so on.

II. Office of a Superintendent of Post Offices

File Heads	Class of correspondence
A	Creation and revision of establishment; opening and closing of post offices and mail lines; changes in the status of offices.
B	Appointments, nominations, transfers, deputations, leave, punishments, security bonds, service books and all other personal matters, excepting pensions and gratuities.
C	Pensions and gratuities.
D	Post office buildings and runners' huts.
E	Accounts, travelling allowances and transit pay; references from the Audit office.
F	Robberies; losses; fraud; serious irregularities committed by post office officials.
G	Due mail and sorting lists; postal notices; notices of hours of business; opening and closing of letter boxes.
H	Experimental establishments
I	Monsoon arrangements, ordinary and extra ordinary.
J	Indents and requisitions; sanctions of contingent expenditure. Information for annual report.
K	Petty irregularities; miscellaneous.

III. Office of a Superintendent, Railway Mail Service

File Heads	Class of correspondence
A.-(Procedure)	General orders in regard to procedure. Books of procedure and other publications. Rules regarding mails, unregistered articles,

	paid station bundles, unpaid station bundles, registered articles, registered bundles and parcel mail articles.
B.-(Personal)	General rules regarding appointments, leave, punishments, pensions and gratuities., security bonds, service books etc. Appointments, nominations, transsfers, deputation, leave, punishments, pensions and gratuities, security bonds, service books and all other personal matters, Character sheets and gradation lists. Appointment etc. of candidates.
C.-(Establishment)	Rules regarding creation, revision and abolition or establishments, preparation of proposition statements and distribution lists. Sanctioned establishment of the Division, and changes in the register of sanctioned establishments. Distribution of the sanctioned establishment of the Division, including changes in the distribution lists.
D.-(Sorting)	Rules regarding sorting lists, their supply, printing etc. Rules regarding due bag statements and lists. Sorting lists and mail arrangement (1) of sorting sections and sorting mail offices, and (2) of transit sections and transit mail offices. Special orders regarding sorting for particular offices, e. g. sorting for Kolkata town delivery Bags; sizes of bags, etc. Letter-boxes; hour of clearance. Hours of business in mail offices.
E.-(Distribution of work)	Rules regarding distribution of work, arrangement of articles and mails in offices, vans etc. Distribution of work in offices and sections. Changes in jurisdiction and headquarters of the Superintendent and Inspectors; opening and closing of sections and offices, changes in their beat, location, status etc.
F.-(Accommodation)	Rules regarding mail-vans and buildings, their construction, repair etc. References regarding vans and buildings.
G.-(Conveyance of mails)	Rules regarding intimation of opening of new lines, changes in time-tables etc. Reference from the Head of the Circle or Audit in time-tables, detention, misconnection of late running of trains, etc. Breaks and accidents. Special trains. Mail steamer notices.
H.-(Stock)	General rules regarding stock, storage, custody and supply. Stationery rate list. Supply, custody etc., of bags in the Division.

	Supply, custody etc., of forms in the Division. Indents and requisitions and sanctions to contingent expenditure. Uniforms.
J.-(Accounts)	Rules regarding accounts matters generally. Permanent advances for contingencies. Permanent advances for postage stamps. Fixed contingent allowances. References from the Head of the Circle or Audit Office on accounts matters.
K.-(Investigations)	Rules for conducting investigations generally. Robberies, losses, frauds and other serious irregularities. Minor irregularities regarding (1) bags, (2) unregistered articles, (3) paid station bundles, (4) unpaid station bundles, (5) registered articles, (6) registered bundles, (7) parcel mail articles, and (8) all other miscellaneous irregularities and complaints.
M.-(Camp articles)	Rules regarding camp articles generally. Movements of high officers and instructions for the disposal of their camp articles.
Z.-(Miscellaneous)	Matters not included under any of the other heads or not requiring separate classification.

V. First Class Head Post Offices

File heads	Class of correspondence
A	Creation and revision of establishments; opening and closing of post offices and mail lines; changes in the status of offices.
B	Appointments, nominations, transfers, deputation, leave, punishments, security bonds, service books and all other personal matters, excepting pensions and gratuities.
C	Pensions and gratuities.
D	Savings Bank and Post Office Certificates.
E	Accounts, travelling allowances and transit pay; references from the Audit Office.
F	Robberies, losses, fraud, serious irregularities committed by Post Office Officials, complaints from the public.
G	Due mail and sorting lists, postal notices, notices of hours of business, opening and closing of letter boxes.

H	Indents and requisitions, sanctions of contingent expenditure. Miscellaneous.
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VI. Second Class Head Post Offices

File heads	Class of correspondence
A	Accounts including Sub-accounts and Treasury.
B	Bills
C	Money orders and British postal orders
D	Savings Bank and Post Office Certificates
E	Parcel Department
F	Registration Department
G	Sorting, Delivery, Deposit and Mail Departments.
H	Miscellaneous stock life insurance.
I	Personal files.

Rule 638. Files in Offices of Heads of Circles In the Offices of Heads of Circles as many separate files may be opened under each main division of correspondence as may be found necessary, each file being given a distinguishing mark consisting of a combination of letter of the alphabet and numerals.

Rule 639. Files and cases in other offices In offices (other than those of Heads of Circles and Superintendents of Post Offices) where the case-mark system applies, as many files as may be found convenient may be kept under the file heads or main divisions mentioned in Rule 637 or under other heads or divisions, distinguishing letters being assigned in continuation of those already allotted. Under each file-head there should also be a 'ruling' file and a 'general' file, and the ruling file should always bear No. 1 and the general file No. 2, in the general file should be placed all communications which do not appertain to any of the files that have been opened and which are not of sufficient importance to justify the opening of a separate file each for itself. Inspection reports, diaries, monthly time-statements and all due returns should be kept consecutively arranged in separate file. Such files will not bear distinguishing letters but should be labelled with the names of the special classes of documents which they contain. Every file must be completed by itself. Whenever any communication received or issued relates to another file besides that in which it has been placed, a copy or an extract from the communication should be made and placed on the other file.

Rule 640. The first communication relating to each subject of importance dealt with in an office should be made the basis of a separate case, and all subsequent papers belonging to the case should be bundled together. To each case or bundle in the file should be assigned a serial number. Those Nos. which are termed "Case Nos." should be in separate annual series commencing from the **1st April** of each year, for each file-head, and be given to the cases under each file-head to distinguish them from one another.

Rule 640-A. The following special procedure should be observed in the Offices of Superintendents of Post Offices :-

1. Basic Principle of File Arrangement

- In the **Office of the Superintendent of Post Offices**, files must be maintained under the **same file heads or main divisions mentioned in Rule 637**.
- All official cases and documents should be **systematically classified and indexed** for easy reference.

2. Preparation of Alphabetical List of Post Offices

- A **single master list** of all post offices in the Division must be prepared.
- This list should include:
 - **Head Post Offices**
 - **Sub Post Offices**
 - **Branch Post Offices**

Arrangement Method

- Offices must be arranged **alphabetically**.
- Each office must be given a **unique number**.

Numbering Rule

- Numbers **1 to 10** → Reserved for **general cases**.
- Post office numbers start from **11 onwards**.

3. Use of Distinguishing Letters for File Types

Each case/file is identified by a **distinguishing letter + office number**.

Examples of distinguishing letters:

Letter Type of Case

- A Establishment cases
- D Building cases
- J Indent cases
- B Personal cases

4. Example of File Numbering

Suppose **Unao Post Office** has **serial number 124** in the alphabetical list.

Then file numbers will be:

Case Type	File Number
Establishment	A-124
Building	D-124
Indent	J-124

Thus, **all matters related to that post office use the same office number with different letters.**

5. When a New Post Office is Opened

If a new office is added after numbering is completed:

- A **suffix like (a), (b), etc.** is added after the number.

Examples:

- A-124 (a)
- A-125 (a)

This ensures the **alphabetical sequence remains unchanged.**

6. Exception for Public Complaint Cases

Cases related to **public complaints** follow a different procedure:

- They must **not follow the alphabetical office numbering system.**
- Instead, the **case-mark must be the same number as in the Complaint Register** prescribed in **Rule 194 of the Posts and Telegraphs Manual, Volume VIII.**

7. Arrangement of Files in Almirah

- Files must be **kept in numerical order** in the almirah.
- This ensures **quick retrieval and systematic storage.**

8. Display of Alphabetical Office List

- The alphabetical list of post offices must be:
 - **Typed**
 - **Pasted on cardboard**
 - **Placed near each assistant's desk**

This allows staff to **quickly identify the office number for file marking.**

9. Separate Files for Certain Documents

The following records must be kept **in separate consecutive files**:

Symbol Document Type

IR Inspection Reports

DY Diaries

TS Time Statements

DR Due Returns

Important points:

- These files **do not carry distinguishing letters.**
 - They are **identified only by the above symbols.**
-

10. Self-Contained Files

- Each file must be **complete in itself.**
- If a document relates to **another file**, then:
 - A **copy or extract** of that document must also be placed in the related file.

This ensures **every file contains full information for that case.**

11. Personal Case Files (Letter "B")

For **personal files of officials**:

- Case mark format: **B + number of the official in the cadre list.**
- Officials must be arranged **alphabetically in the cadre.**

Example:

- **B-15** → Personal file of the 15th official in alphabetical cadre order.
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12. Transfer of Personal Files

When a personal file is transferred to another Division:

- A **new number is assigned** in the new Division.
- The **old number from the previous Division is written in brackets**.

Example:

- **B-20 (Old B-12)**

This helps **trace the earlier record history**.

Rule 641. On receipt in office each communication should be marked with the distinguishing letter of the file to which it belongs, and the Case No. should be written after the distinguishing letter. For example, if a complaint is received in a first class head office regarding the loss of registered article, the complaint should be marked with the letter "F"; and if no other case of importance belonging to the same class has been previously opened during the current year, the No. 3 should be added after the letter, thus F-3, F-1 and F-2 being the file marks of the ruling and general files.

Rule 642. It is not necessary, however, to start a new file at the beginning of each year when the subject to which it relates is continued from year to year. Such a file should be treated as a separate unit and carried on from year to year until closed. If the file gets too bulky to be easily handled, it should be separated into sections which ordinarily might be for each complete year but under the same case-mark.

Rule 643. An index register will be opened showing all case-marks and the titles of cases to which each case-mark has been allotted. It must be understood that the case-mark register is intended only to show what the next number should be. For the case-mark register any blank book will suffice, a certain number of pages being allotted to each letter according to the number of cases that are likely to occur.

Rule 644. In sub-offices (except in the case of selection-grade or large town sub-offices where the system prescribed for second class head offices should be followed) and in Railway Mail Service record offices the case-mark system need not be followed. A despatch register in Form Corr.-10 should be maintained and in this register the subject of the letter issued should be noted in brief, the reference replied to (if any) being noted in the column specified for the purpose. The letters despatched should be numbered

serially from the beginning of each official year and correspondence on all subjects should be bundled together in monthly bundles arranged according to the date of closure of each case. Current correspondence should be kept in a separate bundle.

Rule 645. The procedure described in the preceding rule should be followed by Postal Inspectors. NOTE. See note below Rule 625.

Rule 646. Deleted.

PERSONAL FILES OR BUNDLES

Rule 647. All correspondence relating matters affecting members of the service personally should be kept in separate bundles which are known as "personal files or bundles" of the officers concerned. When an official is transferred or deputed for a period exceeding **three months** from the jurisdiction of one Circle, Division or Office to that of another, his personal file or bundle should be forwarded in a service registered cover to the Head of the Circle, Division or Office, as the case may be, to which the official is transferred or deputed. NOTE. Papers relating to casual leave should not be made part of the personal file. These papers should be kept separately with the authority competent to sanction such leave as prescribed in Rule 102 of the Posts and Telegraphs Manual, Vol. IV, and at the end of **each year** all the papers relating to the casual leave should be destroyed and a fresh series of papers started.

MANUAL CORRECTION SLIPS

Rule 648. When the rules are modified or cancelled or additional rules prescribed, lists of corrections embodying the changes or additions will be sent to each office. The officer-in-charge should, as soon as he receives the lists of corrections intended for his office, cut off the index and the slips and paste them or have them pasted in the copies of the Manuals and the separate Chapters supplied to his office.

The postmaster's personal duties prescribed in this rule may, under the orders of the Head of the Circle, be performed by the deputy postmaster, assistant postmaster in the case of head offices and by the deputy sub-postmaster, assistant sub-postmaster in the case of sub-offices.

Rule 649. Each slip should be cut off immediately below its printed No. and pasted along the inner margin of the page against the rule concerned, and as near as possible to the

particular part of the rule affected. The index should be pasted at the end of the book. The necessary alterations must also be made in manuscript in the loose Chapters supplied to the postmen, village postmen, mail men, letter-box peons, packers, etc., attached to the office, and the officer-in-charge of the office must see that this is done without delay. Exception. Where corrections are not extensive there should be no necessity to paste the correction slip. In such cases the correction should be carried out in manuscript in red ink and the number and date of correction slip quoted in the margin.

Rule 650. As soon as all the correction slips have been pasted in the copies of the Manuals and the loose Chapters of the departments concerned, and manuscript corrections have been made in the copies as provided in the preceding rule and the exception below it, the officer-in-charge of the office should sign the certificate at the end of the list of corrections. When an official other than the one in charge of the office is required to paste correction slips, he should affix his signature and date on the back of the index. It must, however, be distinctly understood that the employment of another official to help him in making the corrections will not, in any way, relieve the officer-in-charge of the responsibility to see that the corrections have been made before he signs the certificate.

Rule 651. IN HEAD POST OFFICES, the head postmaster will receive similar signed certificates from his sub-offices (together with the certificates of their branch offices) and from his branch offices. These certificates, together with the certificate relating to the head office, should be kept on record in the head office and be destroyed after **a year**. In sub-offices the sub-postmaster will receive similar signed certificates from his branch offices when any of the correction slips affect the rules for branch offices and he should forward them all together with his own certificate to the head office.

Rule 652. The certificate at the end of the list of corrections should also be signed and dated by each supervising officer and record assistant. The certificate should be destroyed after **a year**.

Admittance of strangers inside an office or mail van prohibited

Rule 653. (1) No person, those on duty and the supervising officers concerned, should be admitted into the interior of a Post Office or Mail Office, Mail Van or Mail Motor Garage or permitted to take part in or interfere with the work of the office or set. When any person representing himself to be an official of the Department requests admittance into

the interior of a Post Office or Mail Office or of a Mail Van or Mail Motor Garage, he should be required to produce identification or a letter of authority. All enquiries by the public must be made in writing or at the window of the office concerned, and no unauthorised person should be admitted inside the counter.

The postmaster's personal duties prescribed in this rule may, under the orders of the Head of the Circle, be performed by the deputy postmaster, assistant postmaster in the case of head offices and by the deputy sub-postmaster, assistant sub-postmaster in the case of sub-offices.

NOTES.-

- 1. A member of public may be permitted with the specific permission of the officer-in-charge to come inside a Post Office to see the Head of the Office, but in no case he should be allowed in the other parts of the office or to communicate with any other member of the staff, except the officer-in-charge.
- 2. Mail men should not be allowed to enter the mail van except when heavy bags have to be placed in or taken out of the van. They must, as a rule, receive and deliver mails at the door.
- 3. If a Superintendent of Post Offices intends to visit a section in a mail van, he should first write to the Superintendent, Railway Mail Service, of the Division concerned and obtain his permission.
- 4. Railway Ticket Collectors may enter mail vans for the purpose of inspection and examination of passes or metal tokens.
- 5. Railway sweepers may be allowed or called to enter mail vans for cleaning latrines, whenever necessary, in the presence and under the supervision of the head sorting assistant or mail guard, as the case may be, when the train is standing at a Railway Station.
- 6. Parties of Police, Excise, Anti-smuggling and Rationing Departments of the State Governments may be allowed to enter mail vans for carrying out a search on production of the necessary papers and the Head sorting assistant satisfying himself about their identity.

Rules 654 to 659. Deleted.

MAINTENANCE OF ORDER AND TIDINESS IN OFFICES

Rule 660. It is the duty of the officer-in-charge of an office to see that order and tidiness are strictly maintained in and about the office. All articles of stock and stationery should be kept clean and in good order and be neatly arranged in their proper places. Obsolete forms, damaged articles of stock, used labels, broken seals, waste papers, etc., should not be kept in office but disposed of according to rules. The office should be kept free of wearing apparels and other personal property of the officials. Smoking in office and expectorating about the floor or any other part of the building are strictly prohibited.

Rule 660-A. A history sheet in respect of each bicycle, tricycle, stamp cancelling machine, automatic scale (self-indicating and semi self-indicating), wall clock, hand cart and truck, platform scale, duplicator, accounting machine, printing machine and any other machine should be maintained in the following form in all offices where such articles are used in order to keep an account of all the expenditure incurred on repairs and replacements of parts in respect of each article. Each machine or article should be allotted a number. (Also see paragraph 195-196 of Posts and Telegraphs Manual, Volume IX in respect of bicycle and tricycle.)

Register showing charges incurred on _____ No. _____ Purchased on _____ for Rs. _____

No. and date of sanction	Date of charge	Nature of repair or replacement	Amount	Remarks
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INLAND POSTAL SERVICE ARTICLES

Rule 661. Letters, packets and parcels on postal service are forwarded through the post free of charge, if superscribed 'Department of Posts and duty franked by an officer of the Department. Such articles are subject to the ordinary rules governing transmission of each class of article, except where special conditions are laid down. The franking may take the form of the signature and official designation of the officer or the printed designation of his office or the name-stamp of the office concerned. **Exception 1.** The Government of India Forms Press Aligarh, and the Government of India Presses at Kolkata, New Delhi and Simla and the Controller of Stamps, Nashik Road may send

letters, etc., free on postal service in connection with work required solely by the Department of Posts.

Rule 662. No charge is made for registration or insurance of such articles when they bear the super-scription on Postal Services and are franked by an officer of the Department. No registered letter or packet should exceed **10 kgs.** in weight. The registration and insurance of letters on the service of the Department should not be resorted to unless prescribed by rule, or unless the contents are of special importance.

Rule 663. Service letters must never be used as a means of remitting money for official purposes from one office to another when those offices are in account with each other, or in direct mail communication with each other, or when a service money order would answer the purpose. Whenever, in other cases, it is necessary or expedient to send a remittance by service letter, it must be in currency notes and the cover should be insured. In the Railway Mail Service such covers after being registered should be placed with an acknowledgement in an insured envelope which should be dealt with in all respects according to the rules for insured articles. Any infringement of this rule should be reported to the Superintendent or the Head of the Circle, as the case may be.

Rule 664. Ordinarily, small articles of stock of trifling value should be despatched as service unregistered packets or unregistered parcels; but any valuable article of stock may be sent as a service registered parcel. Insurance of parcels on service should not be resorted to, except under very exceptional circumstances.

Rule 665. Deleted.

Rule 666. Communications from officials of the Department, including the in-charge of the office relating to their leave, pay, transfer, leave allowances, fund subscriptions and analogous matters, may, if addressed to the higher authority be forwarded under an official endorsement by the in-charge of the office in a 'Service' cover. No other personal communications from departmental officials are to be sent free 'On Service' on any account. If a breach of these instructions is noticed, the official at fault should be called upon to pay double the charge which he should have paid in the first instance. The recovery should be made by means of postage stamps which should be affixed to the cover of the letter improperly sent 'On Service' and defaced. NOTE. In a single-handed office, the official in charge may, in case of serious illness, send his communication asking

for relief, free on service, to avoid closing the office. A combined office with only one telegraph-knowing official should also be considered a single-handed office, for the purpose of this note in connection with the serious illness of the signaller.

TRANSMISSION OF OFFICIAL CORRESPONDENCE BY FOREIGN POST

Rule 667. (1) (a) Letter post items relating to the postal service are exempted from all postal charges (including air surcharge) if they are :-

- (i) sent by postal administrations or their offices;
- (ii) exchanged between bodies of the Universal Postal Union and bodies of the Restricted Unions, between the bodies of those Unions or sent by such bodies to postal administrations at their offices.

(b) Parcels relating to the postal service are exempted from all postal charges if changed between the following :-

- (i) Postal Administrations;
- (ii) Postal Administrations and the International Bureau;
- (iii) Post Offices of member countries;
- (iv) Post Offices and Postal Administrations.

(c) Air parcels, with the exception of those originating from the International Bureau, are also exempted from air surcharge. NOTE. Letter post items and parcels sent on postal service must bear on the front in the upper left corner the words "Service des-postes". The limit of weight and dimensions fixed for ordinary letter post items do not apply to such items on postal service.

(2) Correspondence on any other business of the Department addressed to foreign countries must be fully prepaid by means of postage stamps.

(3) All correspondence referred to in sub-rule (1) above should be conducted by air since this will ensure quicker disposal of matters.

INLAND SERVICE TELEGRAMS

Rules 668 to 676. [Omitted].



LEGISLATIVE NOTE: Rules pertaining to Inland Service Telegrams have been rendered obsolete and are omitted following the permanent discontinuation of telegraph services in India effective 15th July 2013. (Updated 2025).

Rules 677 to 678. Deleted.

INLAND SERVICE MONEY ORDERS

Rule 679. Postal service money orders may be issued, when necessary, for any bona fide departmental purposes, but the money order system should be used for such purposes only when this is expressly prescribed for when the payment cannot be conveniently made in some other way. For instance, a service money order should not be issued by a head office in payment of any charges when the amount is to be disbursed at one of its sub-offices, as the amount paid by the sub-office can be adjusted in its account with the head office. **NOTE 1.** The expression "departmental purpose" includes the payment on account of the purchase of furniture, if under the terms of the contract with the supplier payment has to be made at the expense of the Department; otherwise the supplier should make his own arrangements to receive payment at the place of delivery. **NOTE 2.** When Payments of amounts exceeding Rs. 50 are to be made to private companies or municipalities at a place other than the headquarter station where there is no branch of State Bank/Reserve Bank, such payments may be made by service money order, if this is found to be convenient. **Exception.** When such payments of amounts exceeding Rs. 50 are to be made at a place other than the headquarters station where there is no branch of the State Bank/Reserve Bank, those may also be made by service money orders, if this is found to be convenient. **NOTE 3.** The Government of India Forms Press, Aligarh, and the Government of India Presses at Kolkata, New Delhi and Simla may send money orders free on postal service in connection with work required solely by the Department of Posts. **NOTE 4.** The collectors of customs may issue service money orders for refunding customs duty levied on inward foreign postal articles. **NOTE 5.** Pensions, including provisional pensions, upto Rs. 1275 per month in respect of pensioners of the Postal Department including those of the P. & T., audit offices, should at the request of the pensioners be remitted to them by service money orders.

Rule 680. No commission is chargeable on service money orders and there is no restriction as to the aggregate amount for which such orders may be drawn in **one day** by the same remitter in favour of the same payee, provided that the limit fixed for a single money order is not exceeded. Exception. The maximum limit fixed for single money order does not apply in the case of service money orders issued by Head Record Offices to Record Office and Sub-Record Offices for payment of salaries, Out Station Allowance, Overtime Allowance and other allowances of the R. M. S. staff.

Rule 681. (1) The following classes of payments to non-gazetted officers belonging to the Indian Postal Department and the Posts and Telegraphs Audit offices may be remitted by a service money order. In such cases the payee's acknowledgment should be attached to the relevant bill or acquittance roll :-

- (a) leave salary when an official is on leave in India,
- (b) pay and allowances (including travelling allowance) due to a deceased official,
- (c) pay and allowances of an official who was on duty for a portion of the month before he proceeded on leave,
- (d) travelling allowance of an official who proceeded on leave before the amount due could be paid to him,
- (e) pay and allowances of officials of Posts and Telegraphs Audit Department on Inspection duty outside their headquarters,
- (f) subsistence allowance of an official under suspension who cannot attend personally to receive payment or has nominated in writing a person or relative to receive such allowances.

NOTE 1. Remittances by service money orders as contemplated in this rule are permissible only when the officials on leave or the heirs of deceased officials are residing within the areas served by the Indian post offices. Payees residing in places not served by the Indian post offices should make their own arrangements to receive their dues.

NOTE 2. In cases in which the payment of a small sum to mazdoors, who are paid on muster rolls, would involve an expensive and unnecessarily long journey by a paying officer, the paying officer is authorised to remit such wages by service money orders and

to attach to the relevant muster roll the acknowledgment receipt of the money order, as evidence of payment having been made. (2) "The amount towards pending claim to personnel discharge from the APS may be sent through service money orders only in respect of ex APS personnel where field post office does not exist".

Rule 682. The rent due to the owners of buildings hired by the Department must not be remitted to them by service money order, except when remittance by such means becomes necessary under the terms of the contract. In cases where a private building is occupied by the Department on a monthly basis and were according to the local law, the department is bound to pay rent to the landlord of the building by a given date and the landlord does not undertake to collect the rent voluntarily, the full amount of rent should be remitted by service money order so as to reach the landlord before the due date. NOTE. The rent due in respect of buildings hired for the use of R. M. S. staff and the allowance of the R.M.S. rest house attendant should be paid through the record office, if there is one located at the same place; otherwise by service money order. Exception. When the amount is due to a Railway administration or a Government Department it may however, be remitted by means of a service money order.

Rule 683. Telegraphic Money Orders (TMOs) [OMITTED]

 **LEGISLATIVE NOTE:** Rule 683 pertaining to Telegraphic Money Orders (TMO) is omitted following the permanent discontinuation of the telegraph service.

Rule 684. (1) The purpose for which a service money order is issued, should be written by the official making the remittance across the particulars filled in by him, as well as on the "acknowledgment" portion of the form in continuation of the printed entry there "Received the sum specified on the reverse on". The coupon may be used for any official communication from the remitter to the payee. (2) "Service money orders issued before the close of a month for the disbursement of pay and allowances relating to that month to the RMS officials working at stations outside the headquarters of RMS Divisions should be prominently marked as "Not to be delivered before the last day of the month and first of the following month in case of pay and allowances for month of March only".

REPORTS AND RETURNS

Rule 685. A list of Returns due from the Directorate is reproduced in Appendix No. 1 to this Volume.

Rule 686. The Director General forwards to the Government of India. Ministry of Communications at the end of each financial year a list showing the official publications, other than those of a confidential nature, printed under his authority during the last calendar year. To ensure the accuracy and completeness of this list, it is necessary that all officers receiving permissions to print any official books, pamphlets, etc., either for departmental use or for sale or free distribution to the public, shall furnish the Director General with the following particulars regarding each publication :-

- (1) Serial number, name of author, translator or editor.
- (2) Title of publication and contents of title page.
- (3) Subject (when not sufficiently indicated by title) expressed between square brackets.
- (4) Number or editions.
- (5) Number of sheets, leaves or pages.
- (6) Size in centimeters or in English measures. e.g., foolscap, folio, royal octavo as the case may be.
- (7) Printer, place of printing and publication, date of issue from press or of publication.
- (8) Price fixed for sale.
- (9) Language (when not in English).
- (10) Number of copies of which the edition consists, whether printed (otherwise than typographically), lithographed, etc.

NEWSPAPER OR PERIODICAL PUBLICATION

Rule 687. Whenever a newspaper or other periodical publication contains any allusion, unfavourable or otherwise, to the action of the Department or of any of its officers, a copy of the same must be forwarded at once to the Director-General by the Head of the Circle concerned, provided that the question is of an "All-India" character, and of sufficient importance and provided also that the newspaper or periodical is of good standing and repute. The officer forwarding the newspaper or periodical must also submit the fullest explanation in his power of the circumstances which form the subject of the remarks, or his opinion or recommendation in connection therewith, as the case may require. In cases where the desirability of such a course is evident, the forwarding letter may be demiofficial.

SECRET AND CONFIDENTIAL PAPERS

Rule 688. Documents (including letters or other communications, official or demi-official, maps, books, pamphlets etc.) which require special precautions to prevent disclosure of their contents, may be classified and marked as "Secret" or "Confidential", Care should be exercised in deciding whether a particular document is to be classified as "Secret" or "Confidential" and the decision should invariably be made by a responsible authority. Papers may sometimes be secret or confidential only until the occurrence of some particular event or announcement and in such cases it is useless to continue to treat them in this way after the event or announcement. The documents in such situations should be declassified by a responsible authority and handled accordingly.

Rule 689. The contents of papers marked "Confidential" (including all the documents etc. mentioned in the preceding rule) should be disclosed only to authorised persons or in the interests of the public service. They should not pass in the ordinary course through an office, but be dealt with only by the head of the office and if necessary in a Circle Office, by certain trustworthy assistants who should be specifically authorised for that purpose. If not passed by hand from one authorised person to another, they should be sent in sealed covers. They should not be brought into ordinary proceedings, but should be separately recorded, and kept in the custody of an officer who is authorised to deal with them. If printed, the spare copies and the proceedings volumes should be treated with the same attention as the originals. Only the minimum number of copies of the

confidential papers as required should be printed and a register should be kept to show the number of copies printed and how each copy has been disposed of.

Rule 690. Papers marked "Secret" are intended only for the personal information of the Government or the individual to whom they are issued and of those officers whose duties they affect. The officer to whom they are addressed is personally responsible that they are kept in safe custody and that their contents are disclosed to the officers mentioned above only. They should be kept in the personal custody of the officer to whom they are issued. When not in actual use they should be kept securely locked up in a receptacle of which the key or keys are not accessible to anybody except the officer responsible for them and when in use care should be taken that access to them is not obtained by any unauthorised person. A list of such papers should be kept by the officer responsible for them and when relieved from his appointment, he will hand over both the list and the papers to his successor from whom a receipt or a charge certificate should be taken.

Rule 691. All classified documents when sent by post must invariably be enclosed in double covers. The inner cover should be sealed and addressed by name to the officer for whom it is intended and the number and particulars of the enclosure should be mentioned on that cover. The outer cover should in addition to the usual official address, bear the official designation and frank of the despatching office. Top Secret papers must invariably be sent by insured post and Secret and Confidential papers by registered post acknowledgement due. These papers may be sent by Speed Post in case of emergency.

Rule 692. The disclosure of confidential information of Government to unauthorised persons is also a penal offence under the Official Secrets Act, 1923, all of which provisions are in force in India.

 **LEGISLATIVE NOTE:** Substituted for "Sections 3(1) (c) and (3) and (4) of the Indian Official Secrets Act, 1889, and Section 2 of the Official Secrets Act, 1911 1 & 2 Geo. 5. Chap. 28" to reflect the current governing statute, the Official Secrets Act, 1923. (Updated 2025).

BOOKS AND PUBLICATIONS

Rule 693. Copies of Code Books and Manuals are supplied to each office in sufficient numbers to meet the requirements of all the officers working in it (See Appendix 3). All books and periodicals supplied to an office should be noted in the general stock book;

and must not be permanently removed from the office for which they were intended. They should be carefully preserved until it is necessary to destroy them as obsolete.

Rule 694-A. Maps

I. Maps of Postal (including Railway Mail Service) Circles (a) A map of the Postal Circle, the scale of which may be decided by the Head of Circle concerned, showing the State, Circle and Divisional Boundaries, H. P. Os., Sub-offices including E. D. S. Os./GDSs and Railway routes as per the legend given below, should be kept in the Head of the Circle's office corrected up-to-date for official use. A copy of this map should be supplied to the Director General.

Legend for Postal Map of a circle

- Circle Boundary
- State Boundary
- Circle and State Boundary
- Divisional Boundary
- Railway routes
- CSD PSD (P)
- GDSS 0
- Departmental Sub-offices (Horizontal line inside the circle)
- Mukhya Dak Ghar
- Head Office (Horizontal and vertical lines inside the circle)

(a) Names of H. Os. to be printed after the indication. (b) Names of H. Os. at Divisional Head Quarters to be underlined. Towns having more than one post office may be indicated with a large Circle with appropriate sign. If at a place there is concentration of offices separate "in sets" indicating details can be provided.

(b) A sketch map of Railway Mail Service showing the beats of sorting and transit sections, and the stations at which the offices of Superintendents, the record offices and the mail offices are located should be kept in the Head of the Circle's office. (c) It is of special importance that both the maps should be kept corrected up-to-date and the Head of Circle concerned should from time to time satisfy himself that they are so kept. (d) A skeleton Postal map of the Circle should be submitted to the Director General in the

month of **June each year** in which all the corrections necessitated by changes during the past year must be incorporated to enable the map retained by the Director General to be brought up-to-date. This procedure should be followed **every year** until such time as the issue of a new map is considered necessary.

II.-Maps of Postal and Railway Mail Service Divisions (a) Every Superintendent must keep up a sketch-map of his Division. In the case of a Postal Division the sketch-map should show the positions of the different classes of Post Offices and mail lines as per the legend given below. Rivers and streams which are crossed by mail lines should be shown in the sketch-map and the places where bridges or ferries exist should be marked on it.

Legend for Postal Divisional Map

- (i) Divisional Boundary
- (ii) District Boundary
- (iii) District and Divisional Boundary
- (iv) Sub-divisional Boundary
- (v) Head Offices, situated at Headquarters of the District (Name in **1.8"** capital letters to be underlined).
- (vi) Other Head Offices
- (vii) Mukhya Dak Ghar
- (viii) Departmental Combined Sub-offices with capital letter "T" in red ink printed after the name of the office
- (ix) Departmental Sub-offices which are cash offices.
- (x) Other Departmental Sub-Offices.
- (xi) Departmental Sub-offices situated at Sub-treasury Stations (Name underlined in green ink)
- (xii) GDSs (Capital letter "T" to be printed in red ink after the name of the office).
- (xiii) GDSs
- (xiv) Departmental Branch Offices (If combined a red dot inside the square).
- (xv) GD Branch, Offices (by a dot red if combined or black if non-combined)
- (xvi) Towns having more than one Post Office will be indicated with name of the main office (Head office or Sub-office) against the sign and other offices indicated in an inset.

- (xvii) P. C. Os. to be indicated by letter 'P' in blue ink put after name in case of H. Os., S. Os. and after dot in case of B. Os.
- (xviii) Railway routes.
- (xix) Motor mail lines to be shown in red ink.
- (xx) Foot lines in black ink.
- (xxi) Rivers and streams in blue.
- (xxii) (a) Bridges by the signs. (b) Ferries by the sign
- (xxiii) If at a place there is concentration of offices, separate 'in sets' indicating details can be provided.

(b) Sketch-map of Railway Mail Service Division should show the positions of the record offices and mail offices and the beats of the sections (sorting and transit) under the Superintendent's control. (c) Superintendents of Post Offices will be supplied by the Head of the Circle with a Postal map of the Circle and the latest survey maps of the districts comprised in the Division. Superintendents of Railway Mail Service may also be supplied by the Head of the Circle with a map of the Postal Circle or Circles in which the Division is situated. All these maps must be kept corrected up-to-date. The Superintendent must take special care of maps supplied to him and in case of damage he may be held responsible for their value. A Superintendent in taking over charge of a Division should note on the charge report sent to the Head of the Circle the state in which the maps were found.

III. Maps of Postal Sub-Divisions/ASPO (a) Each Inspector/Posts/Asst. Supdt Post, incharge of Sub Division will be supplied by the Head of the Circle with the latest map of the district or districts which form his Sub-division. He must take special care of the map supplied to him. In case of damage he will be held responsible for its value. An Inspector, on taking over charge of a Sub-division, should note on the charge report sent to the Head of the Circle the state in which the map was found. (b) The Inspector/ASPO should prepare a sketch-map of his Sub-division, showing the positions of the post offices and mail lines. Rivers and streams which are crossed by mail lines should be shown in the sketch-map, and the places where bridges or ferries exist should be marked on it.

ANNUAL REPORTS

Rule 695. After the end of **every official year**, an annual report must be submitted to the Director General by Heads of Circles. Similarly, Superintendents of Post Offices and Railway Mail Service in charge of Divisions. Presidency Postmasters and Superintendents must submit annual reports to the Heads of Circles.

Rule 696. The annual reports to the Heads of Circles must be submitted by the **1st of May** and the annual reports to the Director General must be submitted before **16th June**.

Rule 697. The annual report will be a narrative of what has been accomplished in the year under review, and is, therefore, no fit place for offering suggestions or making proposals. If the experience gained during the year shows that any special course of action is desirable or advisable, the officers will submit their recommendations separately to the proper authority.

Rule 698. In order to make the narrative in the annual report complete in every respect, the reporting officers will keep notes, as they occur, during an **official year** of all interesting and important events or items relating to the administration of their Circles. Divisions, or Offices, as the case may be or to the work in any branch of postal. These notes will be handed to the relieving officer on each occasion of transfer of charge. The Superintendents of Post Offices and Railway Mails Service will keep these notes in their memorandum books.

Rule 699. Deleted.

Rule 700. The annual reports will contain a brief sketch of the principal matters that have engaged attention during the year under report and may contain any remarks of interest on the different branches of work and their progress. Interesting photographs relating to the activities of the Department on important events during the year should also be attached to the report. The reports will then deal with statistical information and any specially noteworthy features in the statistical information must be reviewed and explained.

Rule 701. Special mention should be made of the principal improvements effected and also of those officers who have distinguished themselves by extraordinary merit. It would obviously be out of place to submit a list of all those who have worked well and the notice

required should be confined to officers who have come prominently forward by a thoroughly satisfactory discharge of duty of an exceptional character.

Rule 702. The report will be accompanied by statistical information in the forms mentioned below :-

Report relating to	To be accompanied by statistics in
Postal (Including Railway Mail Service) Circles	Forms A. R.-1 (Part I and II), A. R.-(a), A. R.-1 (b), A. R.-3, A. R.-4, A. R.-5, A. R.-6, A. R.-7, A. R.-8, A. R.-9, A. R.-10, and A. R.-11
Postal Divisions	Forms A. R.-12, A. R.-13, A. R.-14, A. R.-15, A. R.-17, A. R.-19, and A. R.-20
Railway Mail Service Divisions	Forms A. R.-13, A. R.-16, A. R.-18, A. R.-19, A. R.-20
Presidency Post Offices	Forms A. R.-12, A. R.-13, A. R.-14, A. R.-15, A. R.-17, A. R.-19, and A. R.-20.

NOTE 1. The returns to be submitted by Superintendent of Post Offices must include the figures of all the post offices (except Presidency Post Offices) situated in their Divisions whether these offices are subordinate to them or not.

NOTE 2. Forms A. R. 1 to A. R. 20 will not be available in print. They should be prepared in manuscript.

Rule 703. Remarks on the following points should be included in the annual reports submitted by Circles.

I-Post Offices

(a) Not Printed.

(b) Cases of highway robberies of special importance.

(c) Cases of loss of Government money which are of special importance.

(d) Cases of special importance in which servants of the post office committed offences punishable by law.

(e) Cases in which there was a large number of dismissals due to any general cause such as a strike or desertion on account of the plague or other epidemic. The report should show by whom the dismissals were ordered and should contain any other remarks that may be called for.

(f) Numerous or serious complaints against any particular office or section.

(g) Cases of misconnections of special importance.

(h) The following information relating to Departmental Co-operative Societies:-(1) number of societies, (2) total number of members, (3) total subscribed capital, and (4) the total amount of loans granted to member, each item being compared with the figures of the previous year.

(i) Number of window delivery and post box tickets and post bag permits issued and the income derived from these sources.

(j) Number of head and sub-savings bank as compared with the number in the previous year.

NOTE. The Head of any Circle may, however, report on other matters of interest in his Circle. For instance, the Postmaster-General, Mumbai, may report on the working of the European mail service and foreign post, the Postmaster-General, Chennai, may furnish particulars relating to the parcel exchange with other countries and so on.

(k) A paragraph on "Extension of postal facilities in rural areas" giving comparative figures for the last **two years** in respect of experimental and permanent post offices opened, closed, etc., in rural and urban areas.

(l) A paragraph showing the number of inspections carried out by the Divisional Officers and also the officers at headquarters as compared with the corresponding figures of the previous year.

(m) A paragraph about "Indian Postal Orders" showing comparative figures for the last **two years** in respect of orders sold and commission realized thereon. Before the figures are inserted in the report, arrangements should be made to have them verified by the

Director of Postal Accounts concerned with the audited figures and discrepancies reconciled.

(n) A statement of postal complaints showing (1) number of complaints pending at the beginning of the year, (2) number of complaints received during the year, (3) total of (1) and (2), (4) number of complaints disposed of during the year, (5) number of complaints pending at the end of the year, and (6) reasons for increase or decrease, each item compared with the figures for the previous year.

(o) Not printed.

II-STAFF AND ESTABLISHMENT

- (a) Number of women employed in the Circle to be shown separately under each cadre.
- (b) The number of officials trained in the departmental training classes to be shown separately under each cadre
- (c) Charges of Postal, Traffic and Engineering Administrative posts in the Circle.
- (d) Casualty statement-
 - (a) Gazetted Establishment,
 - (b) Non-gazetted Establishment.under retirement, resignation, dismissal and death.
- (e) Rewards-
 - (a) Gazetted staff,
 - (b) Non-gazetted staff,
 - (c) Total number of officials rewarded during the year,
 - (d) Nature and extent of rewards.
- (f) A statement showing punishments awarded during the year.
- (g) A brief review of the achievements and participation of Postal Staff in sports, games, etc.

Rule 704. The Statistical information prescribed and the subjects named above have been restricted for the most part to information actually necessary for the compilation of the annual report submitted to Government by the Director General, and constitute all that is required from each Circle. It will, however, be open to the Head of any Circle to deal with other matters of general interest affecting his Circle. The extent to which private presses have been used during the year should also be specially reported. The total

payments made to private presses during the year should be stated, and the special classes of printing work for which this agency has been utilised should be specified; if the expenditure under this head is abnormally heavy in any year, an explanation should be given.

Rule 705. Deleted.

COURTESY TOWARDS THE PUBLIC

Rule 706. Members of the public are not conversant with the rules in the Postal Guide and sometimes unwillingly contravene them, or do not follow the procedure indicated. It is, therefore, expected that all officials of the Department should help the public, as far as possible indicating the correct procedure and how an applicant can best attain his object. The officer-in-charge of an office must invariably be courteous in all dealings with the public and should strictly enjoin courtesy on every member of the office establishment. He should always be willing to give information and meet all reasonable requirements where this can be done without any infraction of the rules. He should study the convenience of persons attending to transact business and see that they are not subjected to any avoidable detention. He should afford every facility to the public, and specially to ignorant persons, in transacting business of any kind, and see that documents and forms which are filled in by them are not rejected by clerks merely because of some slight informality which might easily be corrected.

CORRECTION OF PERIODICAL PUBLICATIONS

Rule 707. The Director General should be kept informed of all changes which are to be made in each new edition of the undermentioned publications by the Heads of Circles and other officers noted against each :-

- (1) Alphabetical List of Post Offices.
- (2) List of Officers of the Department of Posts.-Heads of Circles.
- (3) Postal Guide.-Heads of Circles.

Rule 708. For this purpose, each Head of a Circle and officers concerned should have the publications concerned carefully examined and thoroughly revised in due time and, on

the dates specified in the following clauses, send to the office of the Director General at New Delhi a copy of each of the publications corrected in all respects as far as his Circle is concerned.

(a) Alphabetical List of Post Offices is published in September of each year and its Supplement in April of the following year. Corrected copies showing how the list will stand on the first day of the month of publication should be sent so as to reach the Director General's Office not later than the **1st March** and **1st December**, respectively. Alphabetical List of Post Offices and the lists in the Postal Guide should be in complete agreement and no change affecting either publications should be introduced between the latest date for the communication of corrections and the beginning of the month of publication.

(b) The List of Officers of the Department of Posts is issued twice a year, the first issue corrected up to the **1st January** and the second up to the **1st July**. Corrected copies of the list should be sent so as to reach the Director General's Office not later than the **15th November** and **15th May**, respectively. Any further corrections which may subsequently be found necessary in the corrected copy should be communicated by letter to reach the Director General's Office not later than the **15th December** and **15th June**, respectively.

(c) The Postal Guide is published in September of each year and its Supplement in April of the following year. The lists of Indian Post Offices of the post offices authorised to pay money orders by pay orders and of post offices in Indian States and Foreign Settlements should be corrected for each of these issues to show how they will stand on the first day of month of publication and the corrected copies of the lists sent so as to reach the Director General's Office not later than the **1st March** and the **1st December**, respectively. The Alphabetical List of Post Offices and the lists in the Postal Guide should be in complete agreement and no change affecting either publication should be introduced between the latest date for the communication of corrections and the beginning of the month of publication.

Rule 709. Deleted.

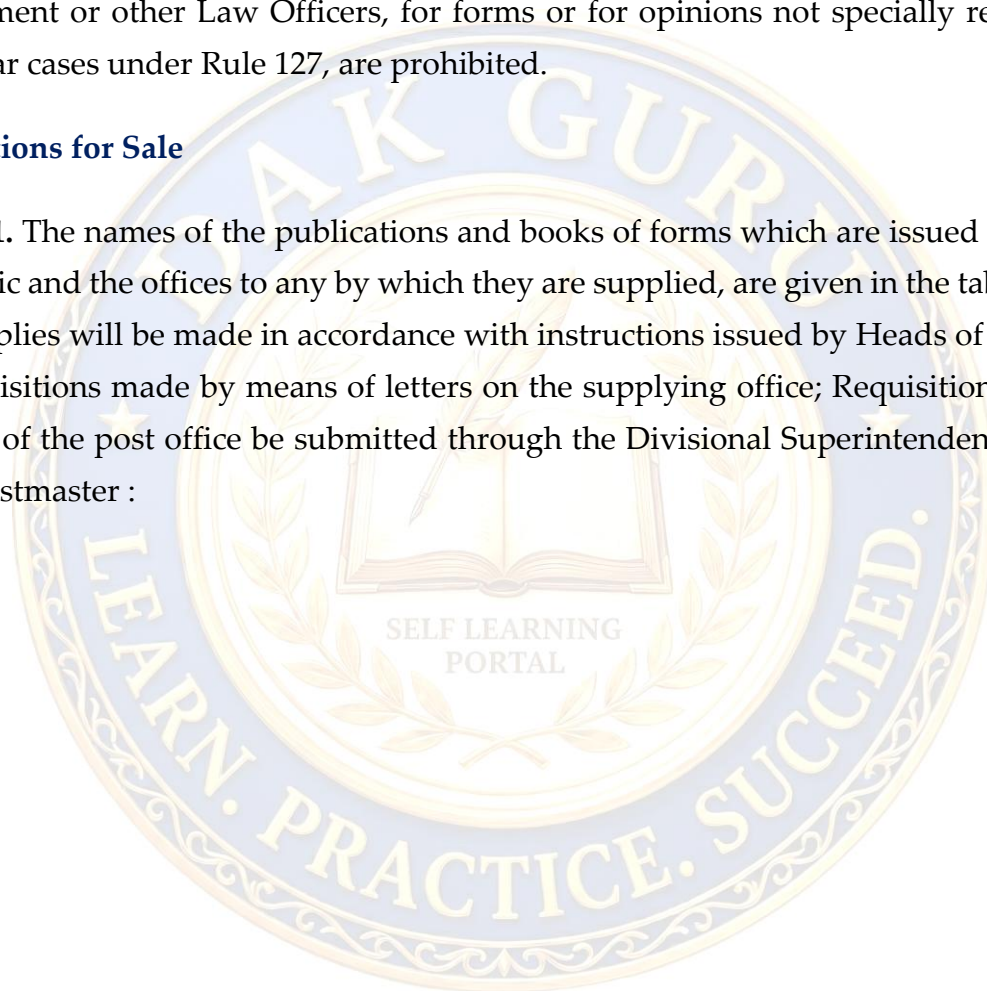
FORMS OF DEEDS AND OTHER DOCUMENTS

Rule 710. Forms of deeds and other legal documents required for departmental purpose will be drawn up by the Law Officers of Government on requisition from Heads of Circles. In case of any document being required to be drawn up by the Government Law Officers, no charge will be made on that account.

NOTE. Direct applications by officers of lower rank than Heads of Circles to Solicitors to Government or other Law Officers, for forms or for opinions not specially required in particular cases under Rule 127, are prohibited.

Publications for Sale

Rule 711. The names of the publications and books of forms which are issued for sale to the public and the offices to any by which they are supplied, are given in the table below. The supplies will be made in accordance with instructions issued by Heads of Circles or on Requisitions made by means of letters on the supplying office; Requisitions must in the case of the post office be submitted through the Divisional Superintendents or First Class Postmaster :



Names of publications, forms or books of forms	Offices by which supplied	Offices to which supplied	Branch to which the publication or the form relates	Remarks
Report on the work of the Indian Postal Department. Postal Guide Postal Pocket Guide in English and in local Indian Languages.	Postal Stores Depots.	General Post Offices (a) Heads Post Offices or such Sub-offices and mail offices as may be selected by the Head of the Circle (a) Head Post Offices and selected Sub-Offices	Postal	
Rupee-Sterling Conversion Tables for Sterling Money Orders and British Postal Orders.	Ditto	Post Offices ...	Postal	
Book of Inland Sent Message Forms, Book of Foreign Sent message Forms. With or without counterfoil. Book of blank forms of inland money order (ordinary and v. p.)	Ditto	(a) Heads Post Offices and selected Sub-offices (b) Heads Post Offices and selected Sub-offices	Postal	

Book of certificate of posting.	Ditto	Ditto	Ditto	
Book of acknowledgment for registered articles of the letter or parcel mail.	Ditto	Ditto	Ditto	
Identification Cards	Ditto	Head Post Offices	Postal	
Agreement Form M-19, Tender Form M-19 (b), Conditions of Contract M-47 and Bank's Guarantee Sec. 30.	Postal Stores Depots	The Circle Offices, the Postal Divisional Offices and the first class Head Post Offices.	Postal	Free for departmental use. The forms Sec. 30 should not usually be supplied unless it is actually required by the indenting tenderers.
Tender Form M-55 and Agreement Form M-56.	Ditto	Ditto	Ditto	Free for departmental use.
Tender Form M-51 (b), Conditions of Tender M-51 (c), Agreement Forms M-50, M-50 (a) M-50 (b), and M-51.	Ditto	Ditto	Ditto	Ditto
Forms Genl. 23 and Genl. 23 (a).	Ditto	Offices selected by Heads of Circles	General	

NOTE 1. The names of sub-offices authorised to sell publications and books of blank forms should be communicated by the Heads of Circles to the Head Offices and the Superintendent concerned.

Rule 712. Each supply will be accompanied by an invoice. When the supply is made by Stores Depots, the invoice will contain the number of copies supplied for sale and, where necessary, the number supplied for use will be separately entered. The number of copies as shown in the invoice should be checked with the actual copies received and entered in the stock register maintained for the purpose vide note below. The register alongwith the invoice should be submitted to the Officer-in-charge who will initial the entries in both the documents in token of check. The invoices will be numbered in consecutive annual series for each office and filed in the serial order of their Nos. Money representing the value of copies sold (including those supplied to and sold at subordinate offices) should be realized and credited in cash in the manner as laid down in Rules 191 and 192 of the Financial Handbook, Volume I, 2nd Edition, 2nd Reprint. Under no circumstances postage stamps (including service postage stamps) may be accepted for use for sale of Postal Publications and Forms. A record of the names and addresses of persons who purchase the Guide should be kept and, on receipt of fresh editions, they should be informed of the fact by service postcards prescribed for the purpose.

NOTE. A stock register showing separately the opening balance, receipt, daily sale of each publication, the value realized and the balance on hand should be maintained. The total of the value realized in respect of all publications each day should agree with the total amount credited in the accounts of the day on this account.

Rule 713. On receipt of a supply of the officer should send an acknowledgement to the Forms Press or the Postal Stores Depot where it should be filed with the copy of the invoice to which it relates.

Rule 714. Sub-offices or mail offices, which are not supplied by Stores Depots with publications for sale, may obtain copies, when required for this purpose from the account office or the nearest Head Post Office, respectively, and remit the value of the copies sold in cash to the latter office. In the case of Post Offices, the remittance should be entered on the reverse of the daily account but not incorporated in the accounts.

Rule 715. Copies of the Report on the work of the Indian Postal Department are also supplied to Post Offices for sale to the public by the Head of the Circle on receipt of requisitions alongwith the price in cash representing the cost of the publications. The requisitions should be sent direct to the Head of the Circle.

Rule 715/1. Deleted.

Rule 716. Copies of the Postal Manuals and the extracts from them, Rules for Branch Offices as well as the Codes issued by the Comptroller and Auditor General may be issued on payment from the Postal Stores Depots for the use of the staff requiring them. The Stores Depots will follow the same procedure as that laid down for the sale of Postal Guide and will receive copies in lump from the concerned Postal Stores Depots under orders of Director General on requisition according to their requirements.

Rule 717. Deleted.

Rule 718. When a new or revised edition of a publication or form is received, all the unsold copies of the obsolete publication or form should be put aside pending the next inspection or, in the case of a Head Post Office, the next verification of the balances of the office.

Rule 719. The Inspecting Officer should see that the invoices are in an unbroken series and that the value of the copies received for sale as entered in the invoices minus the value of unsold copies in hand tallies with the sale shown in the Stock Book mentioned in Note below Rule 712 of Postal Manual, Volume II. He should see in respect of at 10% of the entries made in the Stock Book that the sale proceeds shown therein have actually been credited in the Accounts, viz., the Treasurer's Cash Book or the Sub-Office Accounts, as the case may be. He should also verify by actual count that the number of unsold copies in hand tallies with the balance shown in the Stock Book. The result of verification should be recorded in the Stock Book over the dated initials of the inspecting officer. If any copies have become obsolete, he should destroy them and make a note on the Stock Book under his signature stating the number and value of the copies destroyed.

Rule 720. When no copies of publications or books of blank forms for sale are to be despatched on the **31st March**, the Postal Stores Depot will on that date forward to every office supplied by it with such publications and books, a postal service postcard [Form S.K.-53 (a)] with the words "articles of stock" scored out, intimating the Closing No. of the annual series of invoices of publications and books of forms.

Rule 721. Departmental Identity Cards. These Cards (Form MS-95) are supplied to the following classes of officials :-

(1) Public Relations Inspectors

- (2) Inspectors of Posts.
- (3) Asstt.Supd. of Posts.
- (4) Overseers
- (5) Head Postmen.
- (6) Postmen.

Heads of Circles have discretion to authorise issue of these cards to categories of staff other than these mentioned above whenever considered necessary or desirable.

"In the case of Postal Forms Store, Kolkata and the office of Superintendent, Postal Stores Forms and Seals, Aligarh, Identity Cards are supplied to the following classes of Officials:-

- (1) Record Suppliers working as Booking Sarkar or Forms Escort.
- (2) Cashier.

Cases of issue of cards to categories of staff other than those mentioned above should be referred to the Director General by the Superintendent Postal Stores Forms and Seals, Aligarh.

2. These cards will be issued by Heads of Circles, Superintendent/Sr. Supdt. of Post Offices, Superintendent/Sr. Supdt., R. M. S., 1st Class Postmasters, and other supervising officers of comparable status to the officials working under them. The blank forms of these Identity Cards will be treated as articles of stock and procedure laid down in the rules must be observed. The issuing authorities will also maintain a Register of Departmental Identity Cards.

3. The normal life of a card will be **four years**, but Identity Cards need not be renewed every **four years**, if the card is in satisfactory condition and the photograph is not faded.

4. The cost of the photograph of the prescribed size (two copies) should be borne by the Department for the first issue of an Identity Card. In case of its replacement before the expiry of **four years** from the date of issue, due to loss or damage to the Identity Card, the cost of the photograph (two copies) of the prescribed size, will be borne by the official

concerned; in addition the official will be required to pay **Rs. 2** (rupees two) as cost of the Identity Card lost or damaged, requiring replacement. Both copies of the photograph should bear on the front side the dated signature of the official concerned. One such copy of the photograph should be pasted on the Identity Card at the proper place and the other copy affixed to the "Register of Identity Cards Issued" in Column 5. The copy of the photograph affixed to the Register should also bear on it the signature and designation of the issuing authority.

5. When the holder of an Identity Card retires, quit service, is dismissed or is promoted to a Gazetted rank or is transferred to a post not requiring the possession of an Identity Card, the Identity Card should be returned to the issuing officer, similarly an Identity Card replaced by a new one should be returned to the issuing officer. When the holder of an Identity Card is transferred from the jurisdiction of one issuing authority to that of another he will present the Identity Card to the latter at the earliest opportunity for endorsement. The entry against appointment held will be corrected, if necessary, and the correction will be attested by the authority who will enter the particulars of the Identity Card in red ink in the register of Identity Cards issued and note under Column 5 (space for photograph), the name and designation of the authority whom the card was issued as also the date of the endorsement.

6. The officials to whom the Identity Cards are supplied will be responsible for their safe custody and for preventing their misuse by unauthorised persons. Losses should be immediately reported to the issuing authorities who should report it through the Head of the Circle to the Director General.

7. If an Identity Card reported lost is subsequently found, this fact should also be reported to the issuing authorities and the Director General (through the Head of the Circle). If, in the meantime, a duplicate has been issued, the fee for the duplicate will not normally be refunded.

8. The forms will be printed by the Government of India Press at Kolkata and supplied to the Postal Stores Depots as per demands made by them.

Rule 722. Cancelled.

THUMB AND FINGER IMPRESSIONS

Rule 723. In all cases in which money is paid to illiterate persons on account of pay, wages, contingent charges, money orders, savings bank withdrawals or for any other purpose or in which insured articles are delivered to such persons, the payee's or addressee's thumb-impression should, whenever practicable, be taken on the proper document (acquittance roll, receipt, warrant of payment, acknowledgement, money order, application for withdrawal, etc.).

Rule 724. When the thumb and finger impressions of an official are required on any document in connection with his appointment or retirement any other occasion, the officer in whose presence the impressions are taken should enter his name and designation below the impressions as well as the date on which they are taken.

Rule 725. In taking these impressions, printer's ink (which is supplied for use with metal stamps) should be used with the special pad provided for the purpose, and the following instructions should be observed :-

All grease and dirt should first be carefully removed from the ball of the left thumb which should then be wiped dry, laid on the inked pad and very lightly rolled from left to right until it is sufficiently inked. The thumb should then be very lightly rolled on the document on which an impression is required. It should be fairly laid on the paper and a complete impression obtained by rolling it once from left to right. Where finger impressions are also required, the same process should be repeated with each of the fingers of the left hand in turn until impressions of all have been obtained. It should be recollected that if the thumb or any of the fingers is rubbed or allowed to slip, either on the pad or paper, a good impression cannot be secured. It is always advisable to take one or two experimental impressions on waste paper before finally making impressions on any document.

Rule 726. A Government servant wishing to adopt a new name or to effect any modification in his existing name should be asked to adopt the change formerly by a deed changing his name in order that the execution of the document may not be in doubt, it is desirable that it should be attested by two witnesses preferably those known to the head of the office in which the Government servant is serving. A sample deed form is shown below for reference. The execution of the deed should be followed by publication of the

change in a prominent local newspaper as well as the Gazette of India, publication being undertaken by the Government servant at his own expense in both cases. For the publication of the advertisement in the Gazette of India, Government servant should be directed to approach the Manager of Publications, Government of India, Central Publication Branch, Civil Lines, Delhi.

It is only after the formalities described in the foregoing paragraph have been complied with and satisfactory evidence of identity and execution of the document adduced by the Government servant that adoption of the new name or change in the existing name should be recognised officially, entries in Government records so far as may be necessary being amended accordingly. True copies of the relevant documents should be retained by the head of the office concerned.

NOTE.-(1) When woman employees in Government servant desire, on their marriage a change of name to be noted in the official records, the procedure prescribed in the above rule need not be followed provided the Head of the Office concerned is satisfied that the change sought for is in pursuance of marriage and that the new name is after the name of the husband. The change in name in such cases should, however, be notified to all authorities officially.

(2) When a married woman already employed in Government service gets a divorce and desires to revert back to her maiden name or when a widow wants a change in name or remarriage, the formalities prescribed in the above rule will have to be followed.

Rules 727 to 735. Deleted.

Rules 736 & 737 : Uniforms, Umbrellas, and Footwear

The physical supply of uniforms, protective clothing, footwear, and associated washing/stitching allowances detailed in **Rules 736 and 737 have been discontinued.** These have been subsumed into a consolidated annual Dress Allowance as per the 7th Central Pay Commission (CPC) guidelines and subsequent Directorate orders.

APPEAL AGAINST DISALLOWANCES IN AUDIT

Rule 738. In cases where a reference to the Government of India, or to the Director General, is made by the Director General or the Head of a Circle, as the case may be, as the result of an objection raised in audit such reference should invariably be accompanied by a copy of the Audit Officer's objection and of any further explanations he may have given in connection with it.

PRODUCTION OF RECORDS BEFORE COURTS

Rule 739. A summons from a court of Civil or Criminal Jurisdiction to produce any of the records of a Post, or Mail Office or a certified extract from or copy of any such records will, unless otherwise ordered, be complied with. In the case of post or Mail Officers, the summons will usually be received through the Divisional Superintendent concerned. When any journal or other record is produced in court and admitted in evidence, the officer producing it will ask the court to direct that only such portions of the record as may be required by the court shall be disclosed.

Rule 740. When the summons relates to Savings Bank, Post Office Certificates or Money Order Books, the production of which is governed by the provisions of Act XVIII of 1891 and Act I of 1893, the postmaster will at once prepare a certified copy of the entry or entries giving the information called for, and forward this to the court. The certificate to be written at the foot of the copy will be in the form below, and will be signed and dated by the postmaster :-

I hereby certify that this is a true copy of an entry/entries contained in the (name of record), one of the ordinary books of this post office which is still in my custody, and that this entry was made in the usual and ordinary course of business.

Rule 741. On receipt of a summons the Superintendent/Sr. Supdt. of Post Offices or Railway Mail Service, as the case may be, will decide whether any objection should be taken under sections 123 and 124 of the Indian Evidence Act I of 1872, to the production of any records, and if he thinks that objection should be taken, he should refer the case at once for the orders of the Head of the circle reporting at the same time such particulars as are known regarding the case.

Rule 742. All cases in which an express order is received from a court under Act XVIII of 1891 for the production of any Savings Bank, Post Office Certificate or Money Order Book, must also be reported immediately to the Head of the Circle, stating the date on which the book is to be produced and the court must be informed at the same time that this has been done. The Head of the Circle will decide whether the book will be produced or whether notice will be given to the court of his intention to show cause against the order.

NOTE. All summonses received by Post Office (except first class head offices) and mail offices will be referred to the Superintendent for orders and such particulars as are known to the postmaster, head sorter, or mail agent regarding the case should be reported at the same time.

Rules 742-A to 742-G Deleted.

